Artemis II

Where are you?

Notes from the

Smoky Mountain Astronomical Society

aka the SMAS

The Luckiest Person to Ever Live

Because when I was ten years old, Neil Armstrong and Buzz Aldrin took me (and the other 3 billion people watching television) to...

the MOON!

The Luckiest Person to Ever Live

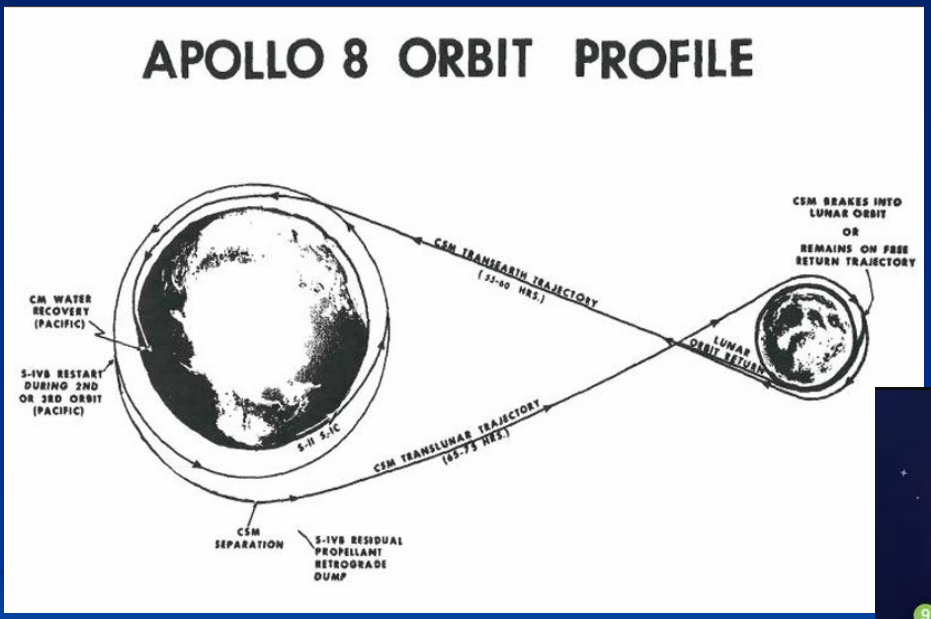
Of course I remember some of Gemini and Apollo 7.
Then came Apollo 8 and the world changed.

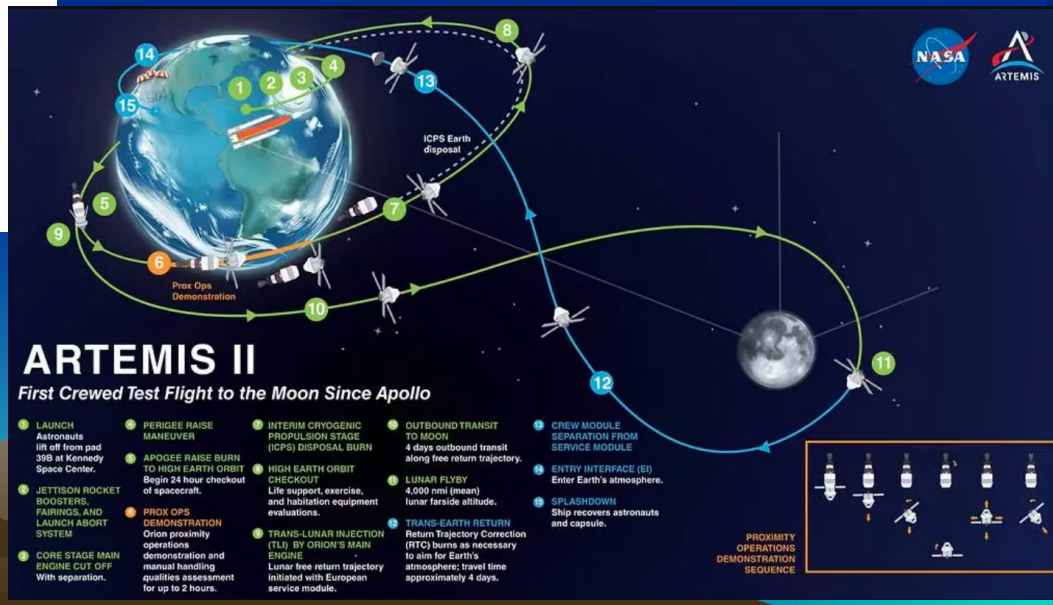
Again We Become Lucky

Bigger and better, Artemis II checks out the Orion crew capsule with a similar trip to the moon.

Compare and Contrast

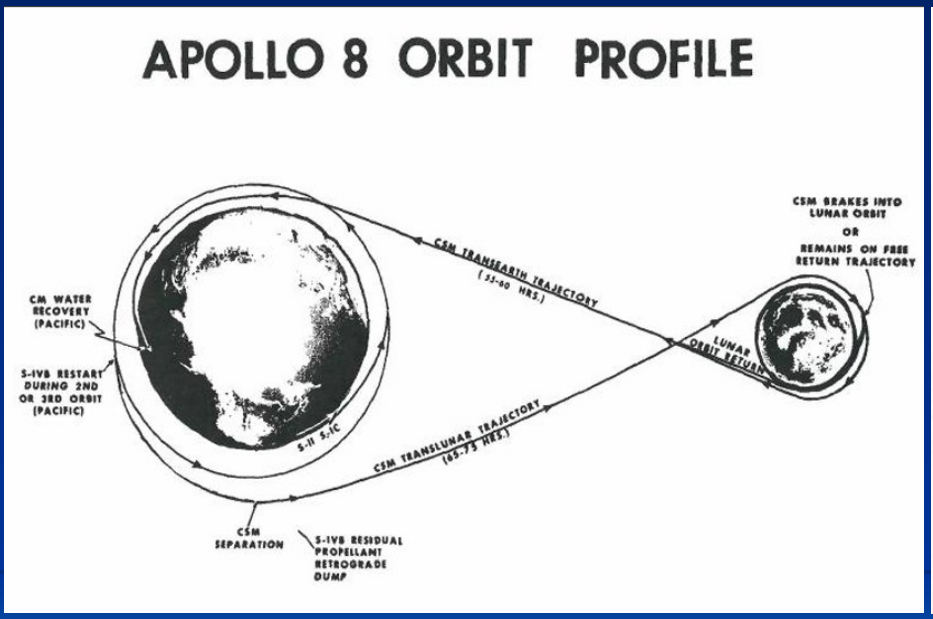
Apollo 8 orbited the moon
Artemis II made a flyby.

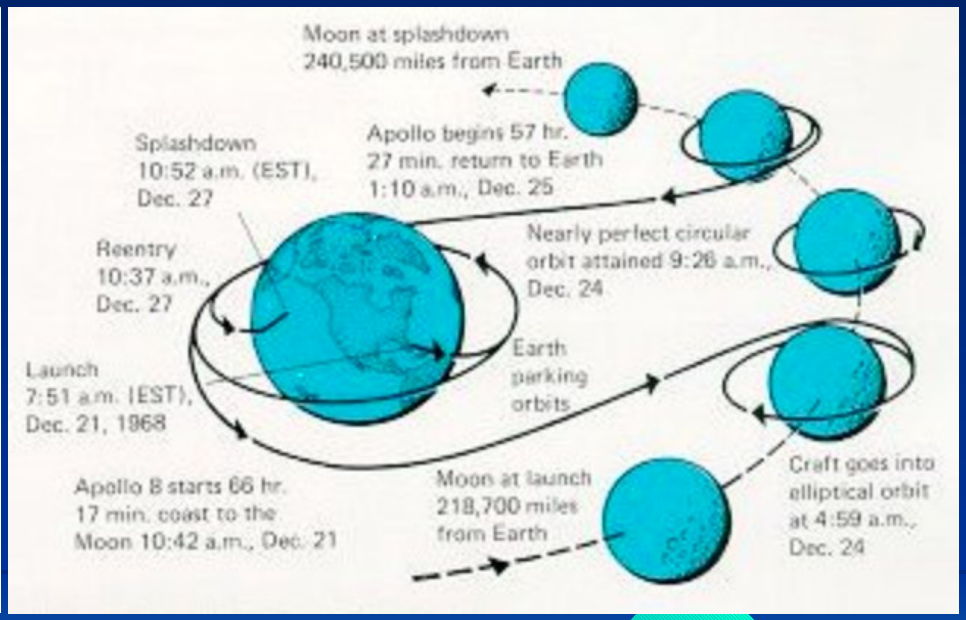




Flight Path Is A Simplification

Apollo 8 orbited the moon. But the moon is a moving target so....



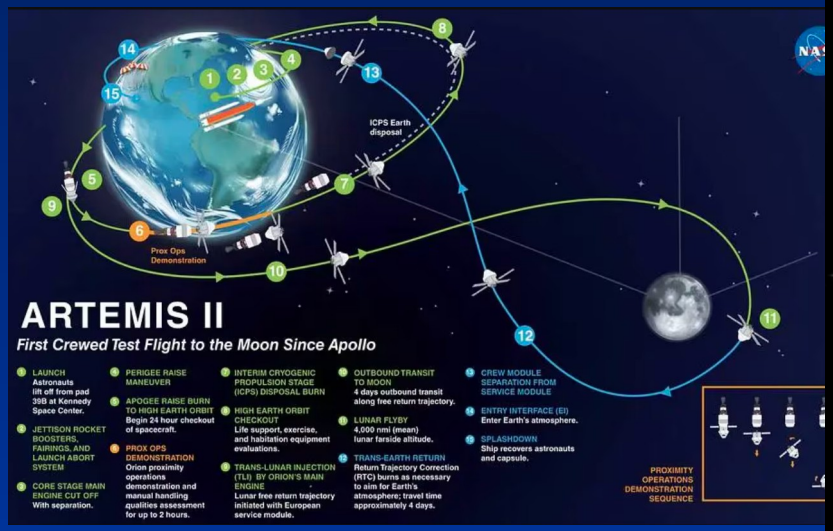


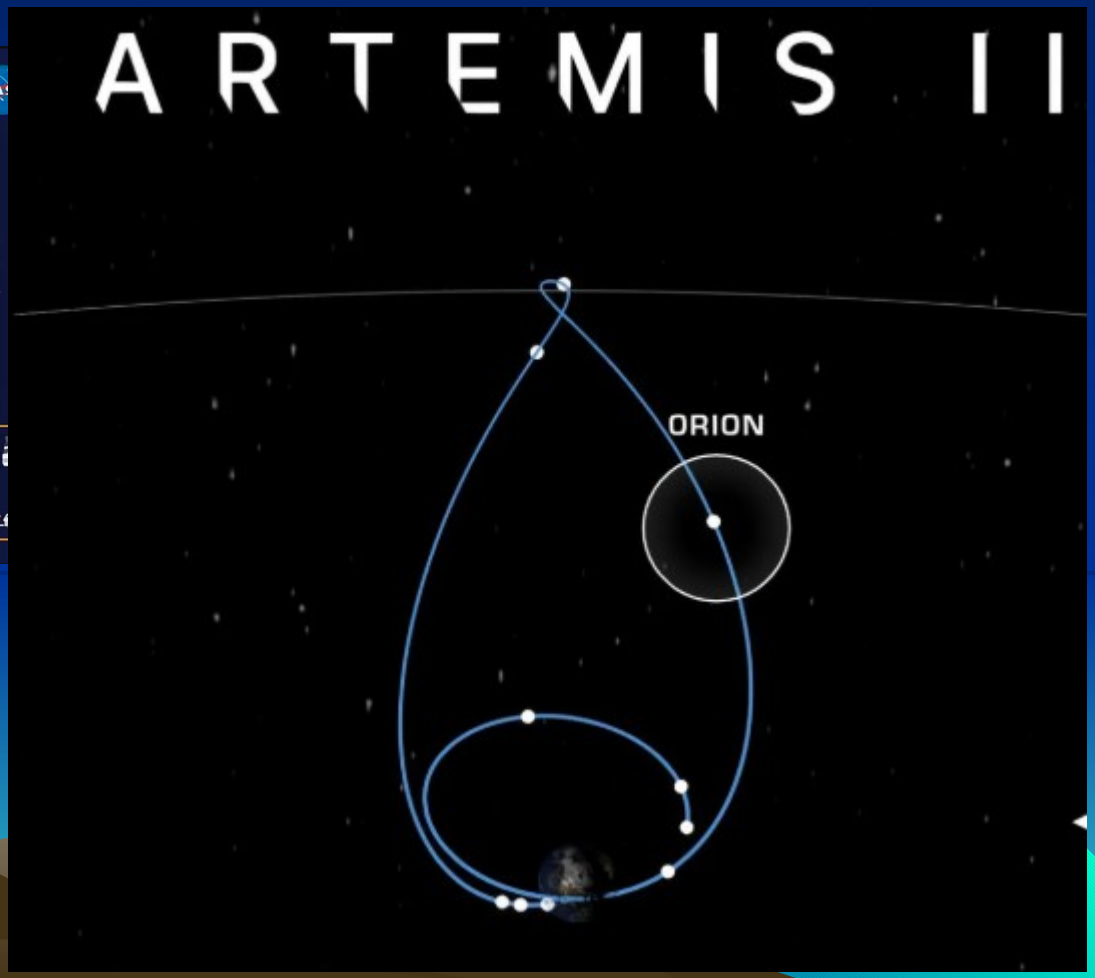
Flight Path Is A Simplification

Artemis II flight path ....

And an animation: https://svs.gsfc.nasa.gov/5632/

Apollo 8 and Artemis II https://www.instagram.com/reel/DWi3WMdDnv1/





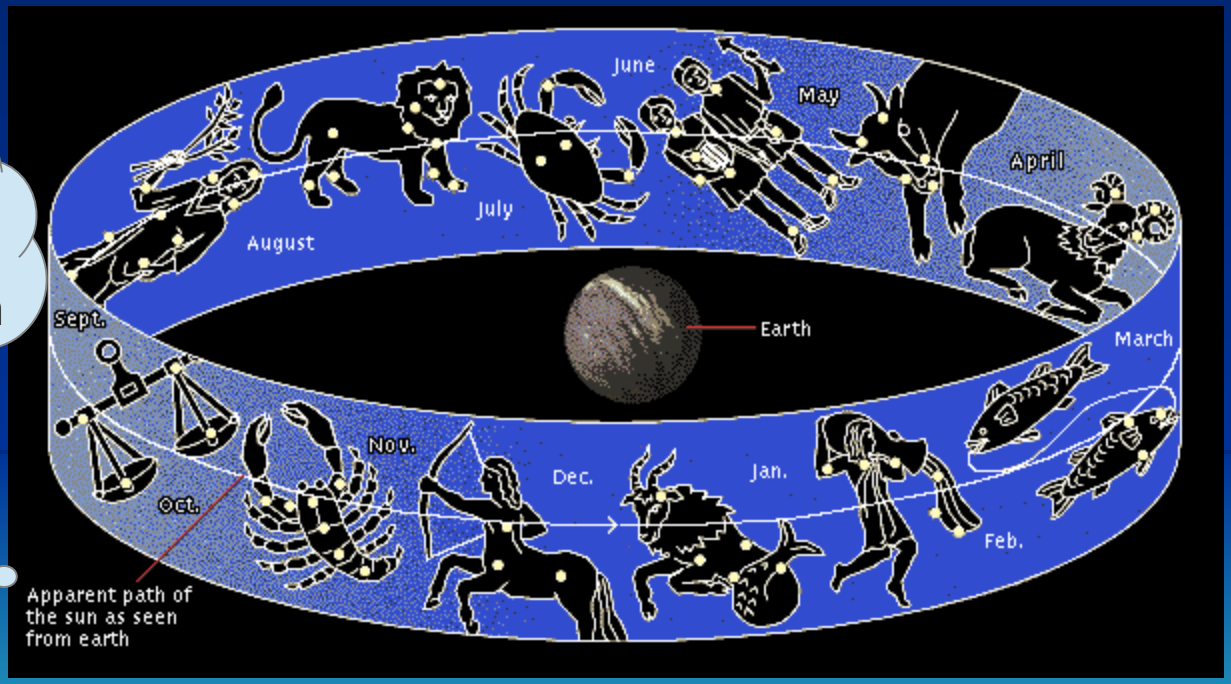
Whats Missing on The Simulation?

Stars. Where are the stars?
As a youngster, I remember thinking Apollo is up there in the sky, but WHERE?

What is the Zodiac?

The term zodiac derives from Latin zōdiacus, which in its turn comes from the Greek ζῳδιακὸς κύκλος (zōidiakos kuklos), meaning "circle of animals"...

Where the eclipses happen



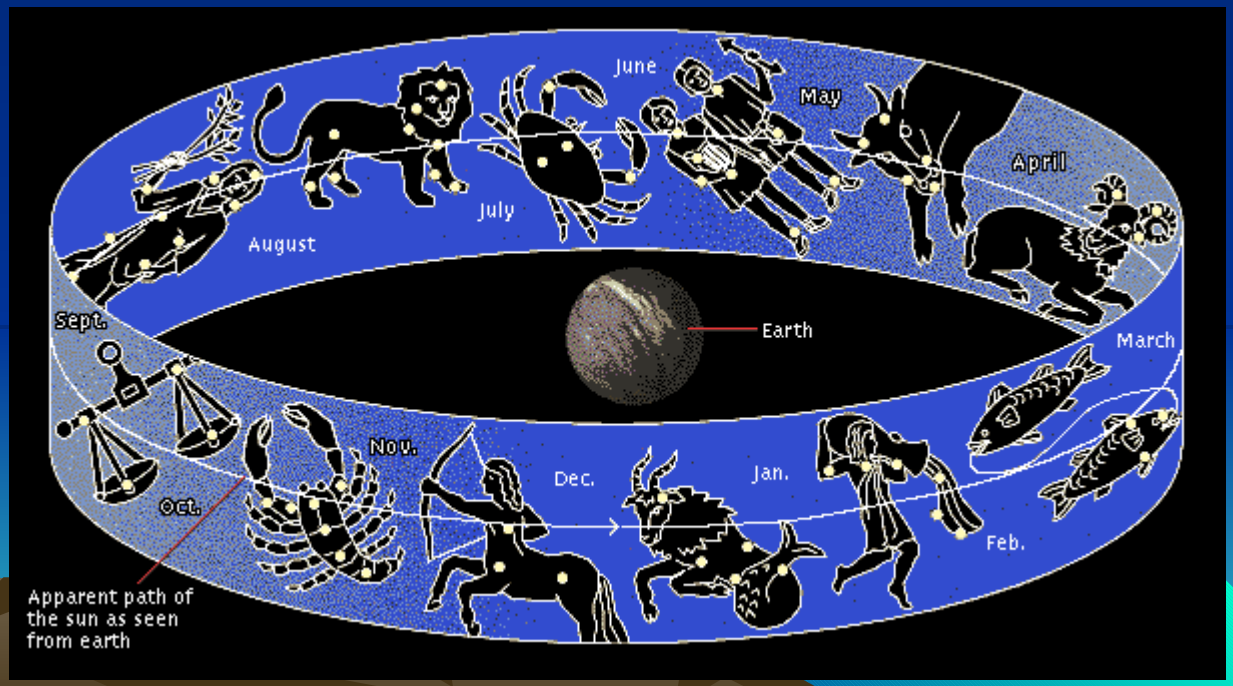
Mnemonic for is the Zodiac!

The Ramble Twins Crab Liverish;Scaly Scorpions Are Good Water Fish.

"Ramble" is for Ram (Aries), Bull (Taurus). "Twins" is for Gemini and "Crab" for Cancer. "Liverish" recalls Lion, Virgin (Leo and Virgo). "Scaly" recalls Scale (Libra). "Scorpion" is for Scorpio, and "Are" for Archer (Sagittarius). "Good" is for Goat (Capricorn), "Water" for the Water Bearer (Aquarius) and "Fish" for Pisces.

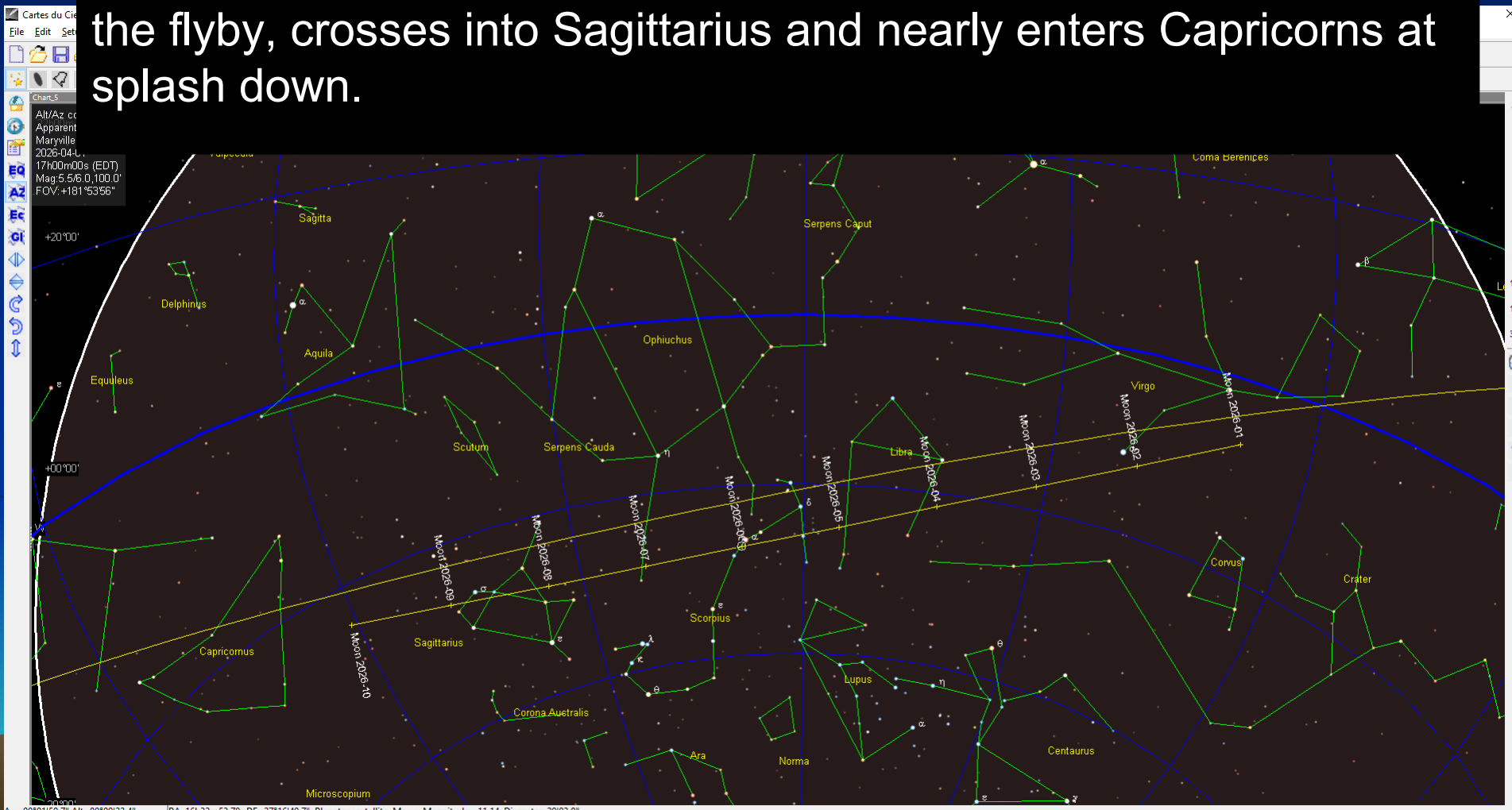
Flight Path Is Where?

Artemis II flight path ....
Going to the moon, when? Ten days staring April 1, near full moon.
For April is sun in Ares(Ram)? No. Its actually in Pisces (Why? Precession of the equinoxes since about 250 BCD)
So where is the full moon April 1, 2026?



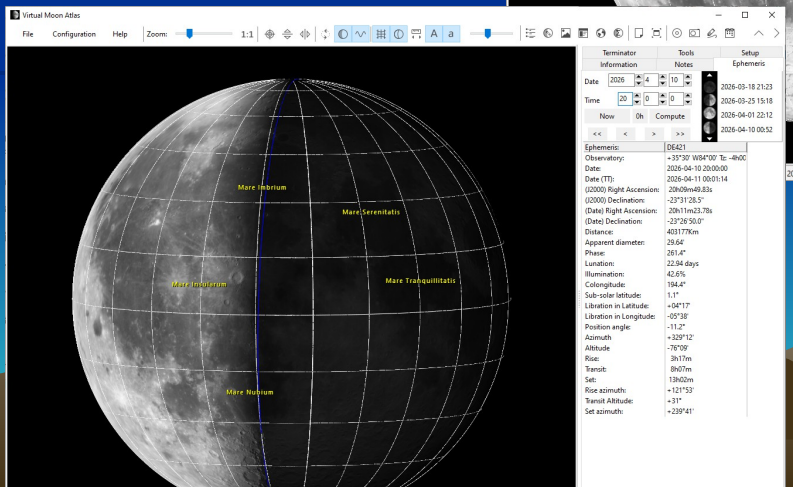
Moon Is Where?

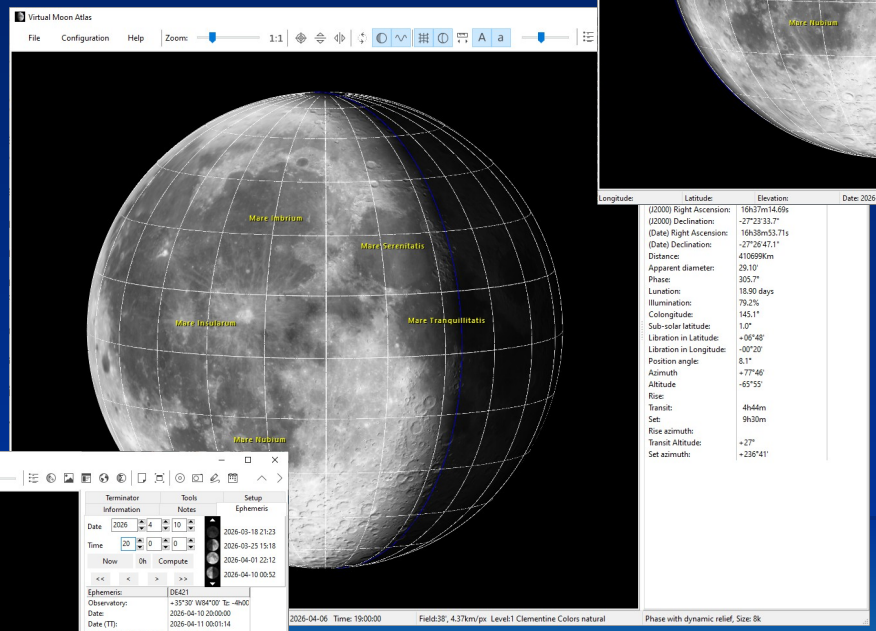
Ten days of the moon moving across the sky.
The moon starts out in Virgo, crosses Libra, is in Scorpio during the flyby, crosses into Sagittarius and nearly enters Capricorns at splash down.

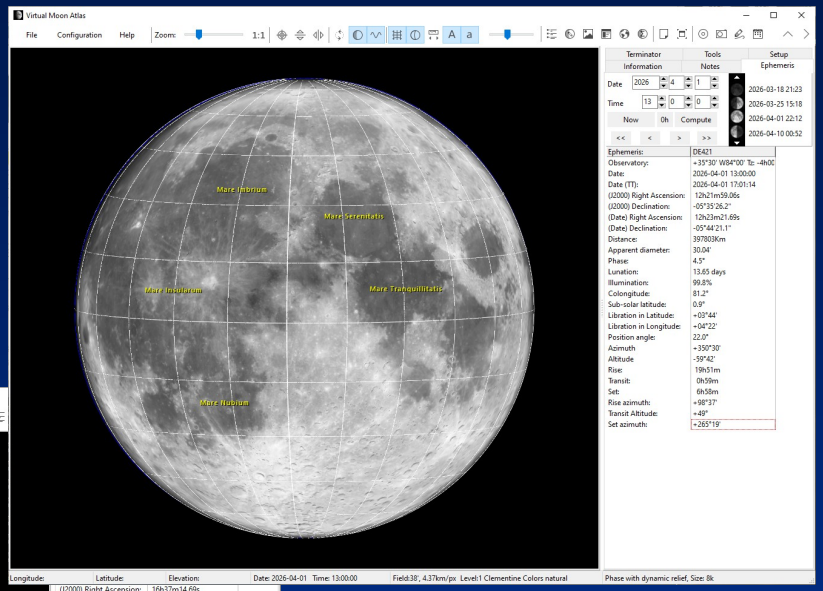


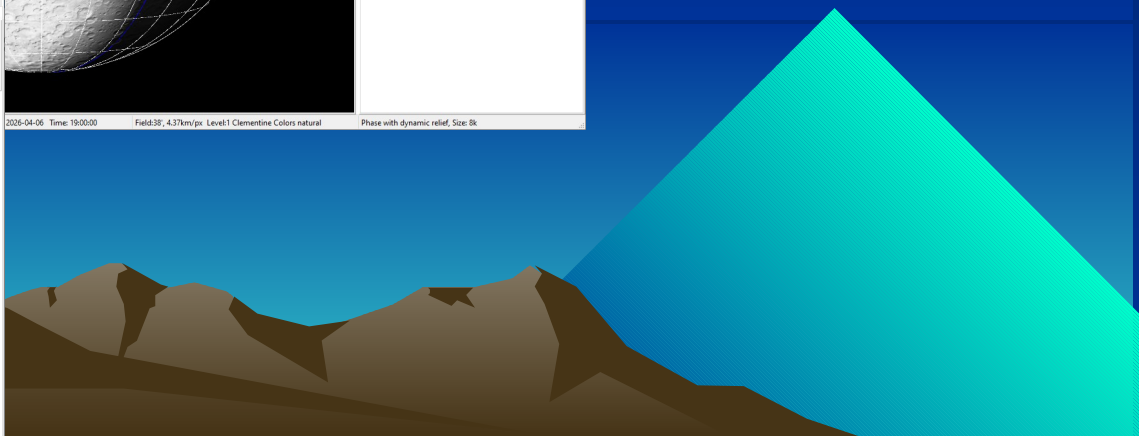
Moon Phases, right to left.

Launch, Closest, Splashdown



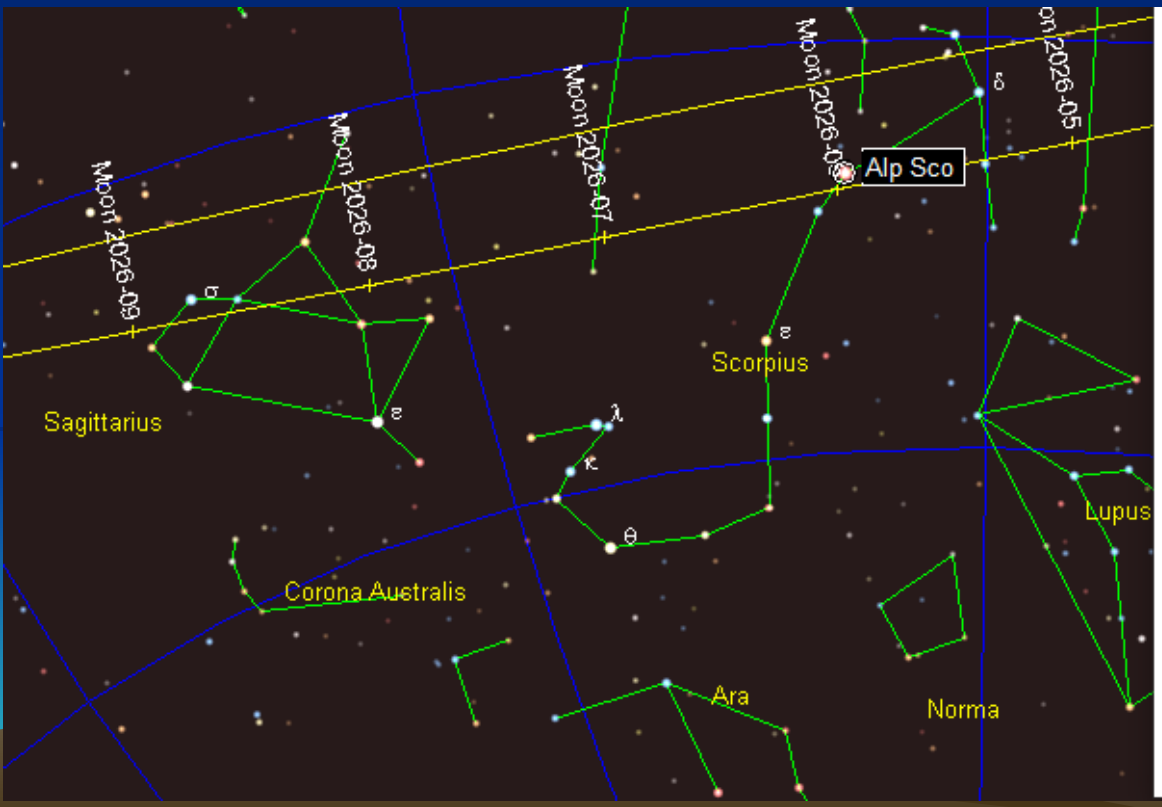






Scorpious is Where?

Using planetarium program Cartes du Ciel information on the selected object Alpha Scorpi, we see it transits (Crosses the center of the sky) at about 5:30 AM in early April.
It is a morning constellation



Coordinates: Apparent
Apparent RA: 16h31m02.402s DE:-26°29'26.16"
Mean of the date RA: 16h31m01.284s DE:-26°29'16.67"
Astrometric J2000 RA: 16h29m24.436s DE:-26°25'55.82"
Ecliptic L: +250°08'00" B:-04°34'23"
Galactic L: +351°56'49" B:+15°03'51"

Visibility for your observatory:
Maryville 2026-04-01 17h00m00s (EDT)
Universal Time: 2026-04-01T21:00:00 JD=2461132.37500
DeltaT uncertainty: +/- 0h00m01.8s
Local sidereal time: 04h04m37s
Hour angle: 11h33m35s
Azimuth: 326°38'48"
Geometric altitude: -79°12'35.3"
Rise:00h49m36s Azimuth:122°49'
Transit:05h28m19s +27°51'
Set:10h07m01s Azimuth:237°11'

More informations:
Search by name: Simbad, Vizier, NED, HyperLeda,
Search by position: Simbad, NED, HyperLeda,

Summary

Artemis II

Where are you?

Artemis II flew towards a rendezvous spot in the sky, a constellation, familiar to amateur astronomers.

Ten year old me had no idea where in the sky Apollo was happening.

Knowing the sky, we can be more connected to their journey.

Any More?

- Questions?
- Your Apollo insights?
- Has Artemis II inspired you?
-
-
-
-
- Finally,.....

Your Most Accurate Horoscope

Unless you go out to look,...

Aries	The stars and planets will not affect your life in any way.
Taurus	The stars and planets will not affect your life in any way.
Gemini	The stars and planets will not affect your life in any way.
Cancer	The stars and planets will not affect your life in any way.
Leo	The stars and planets will not affect your life in any way.
Virgo	The stars and planets will not affect your life in any way.
Libra	The stars and planets will not affect your life in any way.
Scorpio	The stars and planets will not affect your life in any way.
Sagittarius	The stars and planets will not affect your life in any way.
Capricorn	The stars and planets will not affect your life in any way.
Aquarius	The stars and planets will not affect your life in any way.
Pisces	The stars and planets will not affect your life in any way.

Viewing Total Solar Eclipse of 2017

An eclipse is a general term for when something covers the view to something else. You can find a Bonnie Tyler song with another application of eclipse.

These can happened in the sky and that is what we will be talking about.

There are several kinds of eclipses. They are named inconsistently Sometimes they are named for the object doing the blocking and some times the object blocked.

We will talk about a few types to with emphasis on the August 21, 2017 total solar eclipse.

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Friends showing friends and strangers what you can see naked eye, with binoculars and through telescopes.

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Review.
Everyone together lets read this.

Any questions?
Have I confused anyone?

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